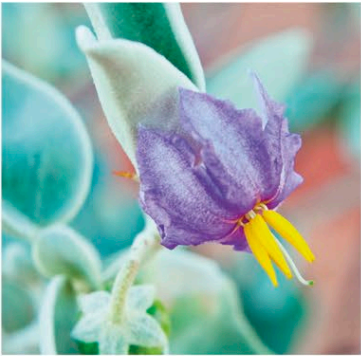


Uluru is higher than the Statue of Liberty, the Eiffel Tower, and the Great Pyramid



△ PURPLE BLOSSOM

A member of the nightshade family, bush tomato shrubs thrive in the Simpson Desert's arid conditions.

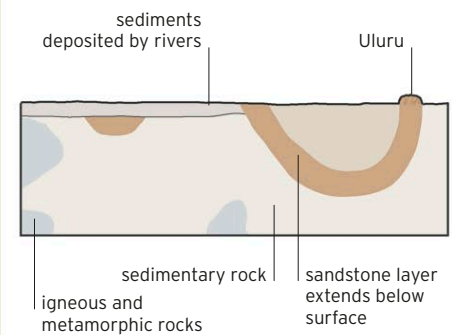
▷ PARALLEL DUNES

The true size and extent of the Simpson Desert's sandy expanses, as well as the vegetation that grows between the dunes, can be seen from the air.



BENEATH ULURU

The rocks that make up Uluru began in the Amadeus Basin, a depression that formed around 900 million years ago. Collected sediment was compressed into a sandstone layer that folded, fractured, and rotated as tectonic activity pushed it upward. Uluru is just the tip of a formation thought to extend as much as 4 miles (6 km) underground.



▽ ULURU

Uluru rises 1,142 ft (348 m) above the surrounding desert surface. Around $2\frac{1}{4}$ miles (3.6 km) long and $1\frac{1}{4}$ miles (1.9 km) wide, it takes about $3\frac{1}{2}$ hours to walk around the base.

